

Irregular Operation and Disruption

Reference: 202311202

Effective Date: 20 Nov 2023

Saudia has updated Irregular Operation and Disruption Bulletins as per the instructions provided below:

Irregular Operation and Disruption

“Flight disruption” is defined as “situations where a scheduled flight is cancelled, or delayed for two hours or more, within 48 hours of the original scheduled departure time”.

- o SAUDIA must inform the guest of all available alternatives and options, as well as explain all of their rights to compensation.
 - This policy applies to all passengers who have completed travel procedures and/or the arrival time specified by SAUDIA in accordance with the general terms & conditions of transport and tariffs described.
 - Planned changes means all flights disruptions made outside of the operational window, while Unplanned changes means flights disruptions that happen within the operational window and at the airports.
 - Involuntary changes are only permitted on the affected end-to-end route/segments of that ticket and does not include any other tickets made separately by the guests. The remaining unaffected route/segments on the ticket should be handled as voluntary change if the guest requests it. However, some cases might be considered for changing the unaffected route/segments according to guest's travel plans with a pre-approval request via Saudia manager in your area.
 - It's permitted to change the guest return/connecting flight if the delay affects the MCT or if the return flight is booked on the same day (24 hours). All affected MCTs, however, can be changed, processed, and adjusted as appropriate.
- o The mentioned below regulations are set out for all flights departing from the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia and all flights arriving to KSA unless the passenger is compensated according to the regulations of the country of departure, such as EU, UK, US & DOT regulations, etc...
- o It is permitted to look for volunteer travelers in accordance with the rules outlined in this manual.
- o Through the SAUDIA website/App, the guest can accept, reject, or modify the reservation, and that decision will be reflected in the reservation record assigned by Saudia. This modification is considered as the guest's acceptance of the alternative presented.
 - If the guest declines it, SAUDIA should look for other options.
 - If the guest accepts it, any subsequent changes will be considered voluntary, and fees may apply according to fare rules.
 - If the alternative is provided within 2 hours of the departure time, SAUDIA is exempt from any compensation for disruptions caused by SV due to operational reasons. Otherwise, alternatives exceeding two hours must be handled in accordance with the flight delays article mentioned in this procedure.
- o If the guest is notified of the flight status, the guest will have five days to respond with acceptance or rejection. Failure to respond is subsequently taken as the guest's implicit acceptance.
- o If a PNR confirmation is needed, a request must be sent to Saudia manager in your area to confirm the same class of booking. In case there was no response from Saudia, it is permitted to proceed with involuntary ticket changes as described in the ticketing manual.
- o In the event of other cases, inquiries, or authority needed, a request can be submitted to the seek authority from Saudia manger in your area, taking into account the ticket validity date, and attaching all documents and special documents to support the request.
- o Saudia manager in your area is entitled to whatever they deem appropriate and in the interest of Saudia for all cases.

If you have any questions or comments, please contact:
SAUDIA Manager in your area

Operational Reasons:

The International Air Transport Association (IATA) defines operational cases as any event or impact on flights caused by a carrier, such as flight cancellations, schedule changes, denied boarding, involuntary downgrade, and overbooking. In case SAUDIA had an irregular operation due to operational reasons, and in accordance with both IATA and CAGA regulations, SAUDIA will apply the following:

- o A message explaining the disruption reasons is placed in the reservation record.

SSR OTHS 1A SV* SCHEDULE CHANGE DUE TO OPERATIONAL REASONS**

- Note that during the involuntary refunds, all non-refundable issuance fees (such as **OB**), and all non-refundable unused taxes (such as **E3**) can be refunded.

Operational Denied Boarding:

- o It is permitted to change the itinerary of the ticket (if necessary) to transport the guest to the final destination, or to change the class of service at the airports on "SAUDIA" if the same class of service is not available without charging any additional fees.
- o If a guest is denied / likely to be denied on a service class and accepted on a flight with a class downgrade, he/she is entitled to a voucher for the price difference between the original fare paid and the replacement fare for the affected route according to the lowest fare in the class in where the downgrade was applied + (50% compensation of that amount).

Planned Denied Boarding:

- o An alternative option can be offered on "SAUDIA", provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service with no additional cost or fees for this change.

Unplanned Denied Boarding:

- o An alternative option can be offered on "SAUDIA", or any other airline based on the guest's preference provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service with no additional cost or fees for this change.
- o If the guest decides to terminate the contract and request a ticket refund, all involuntary refund rules apply without fees + (a compensation of 200% of the value of remaining/unused coupons on the ticket).

Operational Downgrade:

- o An alternative option can be offered on "SAUDIA". If it is not possible to provide suitable alternatives, it is possible to change to any other airline according to the relevant agreements, provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service for the affected route without any additional amount or fees for these changes.
- o It is permitted to change the itinerary of the ticket (if necessary) to transport the guest to the final destination, or to change the class of service on "SAUDIA" if the same class of service is not available for airport downgrade without charging any additional fees.
- o Downgraded guests are entitled to a voucher for the price difference between the original fare paid and the replacement fare for the affected route according to the lowest fare in the class in where the downgrade was applied + (50% compensation of that amount).
 - All downgrade cases are not considered as "disruptions" as long as the flight time is not affected. This compensation shall not be considered as compensation for any consequential damages resulting from the downgrade.
- o If the guest decides to terminate the contract and request a ticket refund, all involuntary refund rules apply without fees + (a compensation of 200% of the value of remaining/unused coupons on the ticket).

Operational Schedule Change:

- o Any changes to flight status are reflected as (TK).
- o If the guest is notified of the flight status, the guest will have five days to respond with acceptance or rejection. Failure to respond is subsequently taken as the guest's implicit acceptance.
- o If an alternative is provided and accepted by the guest, SAUDIA is exempted from any compensation.

Planned Schedule Change (Flight Delays):

If the delay in the original departure time exceeds 2 hours:	- An alternative option can be offered on SAUDIA for another flight within (-7/+7 days from the date recorded on the ticket) provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service on the same itinerary without any additional amount or fees for this change. - Involuntary refund request is permitted without fees.
If the delay in the original departure time exceeds 5 hours:	- The flight is considered cancelled, and the cases are dealt with according to the flight cancellation cases mentioned in this guide.
If the delay in the original departure time exceeds 6 hours:	- Care and support service is to be provided to the guest (accommodation and transportation to/from the airport).

Un-Planned Schedule Change (Flight Delays):

If the delay in the original departure time exceeds 1 hour:	- <i>At the airport</i>, the guest is to be provided with care and support service (refreshments and drinks).
If the delay in the original departure time exceeds 2 hours:	- An alternative option can be offered on SAUDIA for another flight within (-7/+7 days from the date recorded on the ticket) provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service on the same itinerary without any additional amount or fees for this change. - Involuntary refund request is permitted without fees.
If the delay in the original departure time exceeds 3 hours:	- An alternative option can be offered on SAUDIA for another flight within (-7/+7 days from the date recorded on the ticket) provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service on the same itinerary without any additional amount or fees for this change. - Involuntary refund request is permitted without fees. - At the airport, the guest is to be provided with care and support service (meals) plus a compensation is made in the amount of (50 Special Drawing Right).
If the delay in the original departure time exceeds 4 hours:	- An alternative option can be offered on "SAUDIA". If it is not possible to provide suitable alternatives, it is possible to change to any other airline according to the relevant agreements, provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service for the affected route without any additional amount or fees for these changes. - Involuntary refund request is permitted without fees.
If the delay in the original departure time exceeds 5 hours:	- The flight is considered cancelled, and the cases are dealt with according to the flight cancellation cases mentioned in this guide.

Sales Procedures for Travel Agencies	 السعودية Saudia 	إجراءات المبيعات لوكالات السفر والسياحة
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If the delay in the original departure time exceeds 6 hours:	- An alternative option can be offered on "SAUDIA". If it is not possible to provide suitable alternatives, it is possible to change to any other airline according to the relevant agreements, provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service for the affected route without any additional amount or fees for these changes. - Care and support service is to be provided to the guest (accommodation and transportation to/from the airport). A compensation of (150 Special Drawing Rights) will be given.
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All Planned/Un-Planned Schedule Change (Bringing Flight Forward):

If the flight has been forwarded to a new revised time other than original departure time:	- An alternative option can be offered on "SAUDIA". If it is not possible to provide suitable alternatives, it is possible to change to any other airline according to the relevant agreements, provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service for the affected route without any additional amount or fees for these changes. - Or refund the ticket without fees with a compensation as per flight cancellation article in this chapter.
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If you have any questions or comments, please contact:
SAUDIA Manager in your area

Operational Flight Cancellation:

- o Any changes to flight status are reflected as (UN).
- o If an alternative is provided and accepted by the guest, SAUDIA is exempt from any compensation.
- o It is permitted to offer alternative options for another flight within (a set time frame from the date recorded on the ticket) provided that the guest's ticket is accepted without any additional amount or fees for this change.

Planned Cancellation:

If the action has been done more than 60 days from the original time of departure:	- An alternative option can be offered on SAUDIA for another flight within (-7/+7 days from the date recorded on the ticket) provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service on the same itinerary without any additional amount or fees for this change. - Or refund the ticket without fees.
If the action has been done between 60 days to 14 days from the original time of departure:	- An alternative option can be offered on "SAUDIA". - Or refund the ticket without fees with a compensation of (50% of the value of the unused coupons in the ticket).
If the action has been done between 14 days to 2 days from the original time of departure:	- An alternative option can be offered on "SAUDIA". If it is not possible to provide suitable alternatives, it is possible to change to any other airline according to the relevant agreements, provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service for the affected route without any additional amount or fees for these changes. - Or refund the ticket without fees with a compensation of (75% of the value of the unused coupons in the ticket).

Un-Planned Cancellation:

If the action has been done between 48 hours to 24 hours from the original time of departure:	- An alternative option can be offered on "SAUDIA". If it is not possible to provide suitable alternatives, it is possible to change to any other airline according to the relevant agreements, provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service for the affected route without any additional amount or fees for these changes. - Or refund the ticket without fees with a compensation of (75% of the value of the unused coupons in the ticket).
If the action has been done within 24 hours of the original time of departure:	- Provide alternative options on SAUDIA for flights. - It is permitted to change to any other airline according to the relevant agreements and as per IATA re-accommodation rules. - Or refund the ticket without fees with compensation in the amount of (150% of the value of the unused coupons in the ticket).

Volunteer Travelers:

- o It's permitted to search for volunteers in compliance with GACA regulation

If you have any questions or comments, please contact:
SAUDIA Manager in your area

Force Majeure:

An event or effect that cannot be reasonably anticipated or controlled. These cases include Weather, Security, Diseases, War, Riots, Earthquakes, Hurricanes, Lightning, and explosions, Energy Blackouts, Unexpected Legislation, Lockouts, Slowdowns, Strikes, etc.

In case SAUDIA had an irregular operation or downgrades due to force majeure, and in accordance with both IATA and CAGA regulations, SAUDIA will apply the following:

- o A note in the PNR shall be added to indicate the reason of this operation changes.

SSR OTHS 1A SV*** SCHEDULE CHANGE DUE TO FORCE MAJEURE

- o Rebooking/Revalidation/Reroute:
 - an alternative option can be offered on SAUDIA for another flight within (-7/+7 days from the date recorded on the ticket) provided that the guest's ticket is accepted in the same class of service on the same itinerary without any additional amount or fees for this change.
 - In case the alternative offered was declined, SAUDIA should look for other alternative options for the same (7 days) period without fees based on flights' availabilities and airlines agreements. However, if the offer was accepted, SAUDIA should consider any changes afterwards as voluntary change and fees maybe applies according to the RBD fare note.
 - It is permitted to change the class of service or re-route the ticket if requested by the guest. The additional amount should be collected, if any without collecting re-issuing fees.
 - The change should be for the affected segment/route on the affected ticket only, not including other tickets issued by the guest.
- o Refund:
 - It is permitted to refund the unused ticket, or the remaining part of the ticket without refund fees.
 - *Note that the non-refundable issuance fees (such as OB issuance Fees), and non-refundable taxes (such as E3) cannot be refunded.*
- o Compensations:
 - All compensation rules should not be applied in such cases.

Exceptional Cases:

IATA defines (immediate family members) of a traveler to include spouse, wife, children (including adopted children), parents, brother, sister, grandfather, grandmother, grandson, the father-in-law, the mother-in-law, the brother of the husband/wife, the sister of the husband/wife, the son of the husband/wife, the daughter of the husband/wife.

Death Cases

- o The death of the traveler or a member of his immediate family. The date of travel must occur within a period of 3 months from the date of death.

Severe Illnesses, and Hospital Admissions

- o Hospitalization of the traveler and/or a member of his immediate family or being exposed to a health condition at the airport or on the plane before take-off. A medical report approved by a government or private hospital or from the health unit at the airport should be attached, along with a letter from the airport duty manager for airport cases.

Judicial or criminal judgments

- o The appearance of the traveler in a judicial or criminal hearing, or may be arrested, imprisoned, or in cases of stolen documents or any similar cases.

Refusal to board by the authorities of the travelling country

- o In the event that the local authorities issue a decision preventing the traveler from entering its territory after he has completed all the documents that authorize him to enter that country. Attaching a copy of the list received from that country indicating the name of the traveler and the letter of the duty manager.

Procedures:

- o All requests must be submitted to Saudia Manager in your Area to seek approvals, taking into account the ticket validity date, and attaching all documents and special documents to support the request.
- o All processed requests without approvals are subject to violations.

Inadmissible Passenger:

As per ICAO regulations, that operating carrier must issue return tickets for inadmissible passengers once the Immigration department decides that based on security information available at those related departments. Therefore, an **(INAD)** account number has been created by SAUDIA to issue tickets for inadmissible passengers.

- o An inadmissible passenger is a passenger who was refused admission to a State by local authorities due to lack of visa, expired passport, or any other security reason.
- o When immigration department decides not to accept a passenger to its country, they will notify SAUDIA to deport the traveler at the earliest possible flight to the original station or any other country that might accept the passenger.
- o SAUDIA must provide a new confirmed booking for the INAD passenger.
- o When the inadmissible passenger is holding a return ticket with restrictions such as (minimum stay, fare validity, group booking etc.), those restrictions shall be waived and return ticket will be used with adding the following remark (Inadmissible PAX).
- o In case the inadmissible passenger doesn't holding a return ticket, then SAUDIA has the right to request the passenger to buy a new ticket on spot. Otherwise, SAUDIA will have to issue a ticket on its account to transfer the passenger to the final destination, original destination, any other country that might accept the passenger.

ATO's Process:

- o Receiving the authorization e-mail containing all the documents along with copy of INAD passenger passport from the station manager or who deputize him.
- o Checking the ticket number recorded in the authorization e-mail.
- o In case the INAD passenger has return or connecting ticket segments, then reissue the ticket involuntary without pricing restrictions, and do not use INAD account. Financial discrepancy note will be issued against sales employees if they issue new ticket while the INAD passenger possess return or connection tickets.
- o Use the INAD account if the passenger does not possess return or connection ticket.
- o Add the following items in the endorsement box when Issuing / Reissuing the INAD passenger ticket:
 - INADMISSIBLE PAX
 - Deportation order number (if any) and the E-mail date.
 - Inbound (arrival) ticket number.
 - Arrival flight number and date.
 - Passenger nationality.
 - Passenger Passport number
- o Book the INAD passenger on any Guest Class RBD apart from SAVER Guest Class.
- o The INAD account is considered SAUDIA special account with the code **INV**.
- o Send all the ticket issuance documents along with the sales report and the original authorization letter (if any) to the finance departments.

FOPGOV/IN000000INAD -XXX-20231115

Whereas **00000INAD** is the account number – **XXX** is the request or letter number – **20231115** is the date.

Usage of Automatic Changer for Involuntary Cases

Definition

The ATC (**FXI**) is used when Involuntary situations occur to re-issue the coupon/coupons for affected flights including the changes made on connection flights and the final destination, and it cannot be used to for voluntary change.

Revalidation for Involuntary Cases

When an involuntary situation occurs, the involuntary revalidation entry is to be used on the coupon/coupons of the affected sector.

TTP/ETRV/IVI

- The involuntary revalidation entry is to be used on Saudia flights only on the same sector and class.

>**TTP/ETRV/IVI**

OK PROCESSED - 5PFSOT

- When displaying the ticket, the indicator (**I**) is inserted next to the coupon status to show that the change made on the coupon is involuntary.

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TKT-0652146141580      RCI-      1A LOC-NARDP7
OD-RUHJED SI-      FCPI-F      POI-RUH      DOI-26NOV22      IOI-71496832
1.TEST/TEST      ADT      S I
1 ORUH SV1049      H 28NOV2100 OK HSA/NET      E I 28NOV28NOV 2PC
JED
FARE      F SAR      548.00
TOTALTAX SAR      151.20
TOTAL      SAR      699.20
/FC RUH SV JED548.00SAR548.00END
FE TKT VALD 1Y FRM ISSUE DATE

```

Re-issue for Involuntary Cases

In case of involuntary changes, the involuntary re-issue entry is to be used on coupon/coupons of the affected flight.

FXI

- When displaying the ticket, the indicator (**I**) is inserted next to the coupon status to show that the change made on the coupon is involuntary.

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TKT-0652146217232      RCI-      1A LOC-NARDP7
OD-RUHJED SI-      FCPI-4      POI-RUH      DOI-28NOV22      IOI-71401002
1.TEST/TEST      ADT      S I
1 ORUH SV1047      Y 28NOV2000 OK HSA/NET      O      28NOV 2PC
JED
FARE      R SAR      548.00
TOTALTAX SAR      0.00
TAXES      PD
TOTAL      SAR      NO ADC
/FC I-28NOV22RUH SV JED548.00SAR548.00END
FE INVOL REROUTE TKT VALD 1Y FRM ISSUE DATE

```

- The Endorsement Field (**FE**) should be inserted automatically.

FE PAX INVOL REROUTE TKT VALD 1Y FRM ISSUE DATE

- The indicator (**I**) should automatically be inserted in the FO next to the coupon.

FO PAX 065-2146141580RUH26NOV22/71496832/065-21461415806E1*

The ticket and coupon number must be specified as per the ticket sequence, and re-issue the affected coupon/coupons, while keeping the unaffected coupons in the original ticket (good for use). Not specifying the coupon will lead to the re-issuance of all coupons.

FXI/TKT065-12345678901 **I1-2/S2**

Note:

- o The Involuntary re-issuance for all coupons on (065) tickets with purely Saudia flights, can be made if the change is more than 24 hours before time of departure; and on the affected coupon/sector if it is within 24 hours of time departure.
- o The involuntary re-issuance for codeshare flights and flights operated by OAL is carried out as per the agreements that are in place, which is the affected sector only.
- o The involuntary re-issuance for travel agencies tickets is carried out by the same travel agency. Otherwise, and within 24 hours, all SV agents on all channels can interact with affected coupons only.
- o The (FIM) form is used in case of changes made on OAL flights if there are no coupons available as per (IATA Resolution 722F).

SAUDIA new tools to handle disruptions:

Reissue for Involuntary Cases via ER (Enhance Re-accommodation)

- o Manger SAUDIA in the area receives and handle the cases for flights departing between 365 days to 24 hours and are responsible for the output of this system.

Reissue for Involuntary Cases via OPR (Operation Passenger Recovery)

- o Manger SAUDIA in the area receive and handle the cases for flights departing between 24 to 6 hours.

Reissue for Involuntary Cases via DT (Distribution Transfer)

- o Manger SAUDIA in the area receive and handle the cases for flights departing within 6 hours.

Reissue for Involuntary Cases via Self-Reacc (Self Reaccommodating)

All of the above-mentioned tools are designed to:

- o Provides an alternative from “Saudia” on flight/flights that is changed or cancelled.
- o The guest has the right to accept or decline the offered alternatives as described here.
- o In case the system failed to re-issue the ticket, or it was issued incorrectly, changes are to be made without fee and this kind of change is to be considered as a corrective action and not as an option presented to the guest.

Compensation

In implementation of the Executive Regulations for the Protection of Customers' Rights of the General Authority of Civil Aviation and without prejudice to the provisions of international treaties to which the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia is organized and their amendments, the provisions of this regulation shall apply to:

- o All "Saudia" flights departing from the airports of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.
- o SAUDIA flights coming to the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia unless the traveler is compensated or assisted in accordance with the regulations of the country of departure.
- o All guests must submit a complaint to the Guest Relations Department through the "Feedback and Complaints" form on the [Saudia website](#) or via the email ([Guest Relations Support](#)). Ground Operation Team & ATOs should not issue any paper DBC forms and send any issued DBCs to the same email address for further handling.

Saudi Arabia:

<https://gaca.gov.sa/web/ar-sa/page/laws-regulation>

EU:

Delays & Flight Cancellation:

https://europa.eu/youreurope/citizens/travel/passenger-rights/air/index_en.htm

Denied and Downgrade:

- o Manger SAUDIA in the area must hand over the (DBC) paper forms to guests and are disbursed from sales offices according to EU law.

https://europa.eu/youreurope/citizens/travel/passenger-rights/air/index_en.htm#deniedBoarding

https://europa.eu/youreurope/citizens/travel/passenger-rights/air/index_en.htm#upgradeAndDowngrade

UK:

Delays & Flight Cancellation:

<https://www.caa.co.uk/passengers/resolving-travel-problems/delays-and-cancellations/>

Denied and Downgrade:

- o Manger SAUDIA in the area must hand over the (DBC) paper forms to guests and are disbursed from sales offices according to UK law.

<https://www.caa.co.uk/passengers/resolving-travel-problems/delays-and-cancellations/denied-boarding/>

<https://www.caa.co.uk/passengers/resolving-travel-problems/delays-and-cancellations/downgrading/>

USA:

- o Manger SAUDIA in the area must hand over the (DBC) paper forms to guests and are disbursed from sales offices according to US law.

<https://www.transportation.gov/individuals/aviation-consumer-protection/bumping-oversales>